



PREVENTION OVER PRESCRIPTION

Harm Reduction and HIV Prevention

WHAT IS HIV?

Human Immunodeficiency Virus (HIV) attacks the body's immune system.

- Makes it **harder** to fight infections
- If left untreated, it can lead to AIDS (Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome) [2]

WHO IS AT RISK?

- 2SLGBTQI+
- Underserved communities
- Sex workers
- Individuals who use self-injection methods [3]

But... anyone can get HIV

HOW DOES HIV SPREAD?

Sharing **needles/Blood**



Unprotected sex (semen, vaginal and rectal fluids)

Birth/breastfeeding to babies

HIV is **NOT** spread through casual contact



[2]

HARM REDUCTION

Your safety is important! We can keep people safe by focusing on **prevention over prescription** through non-judgemental, equitable strategies. [1]

HOW CAN WE REDUCE HIV RISK?

1 SAFER SEX

Before Exposure: PrEP



lower sexual transmission risk [5]

Pre-exposure Prophylaxis (**PrEP**) is an HIV-prevention medication for at risk individuals

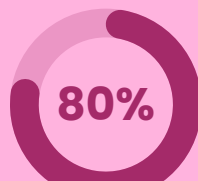


During Sex: Condoms



During sex, latex condoms act as a barrier, lowering HIV/STI risk [6]

After Exposure: PEP



reduced infection risk [7]

Post-exposure Prophylaxis (**PEP**) is emergency HIV medication taken within **72 hours for 28 days** after potential exposure

Long Term: HIV Testing and U=U



~1 in 9 Canadians

with HIV may not know their status [15]

- When correctly treated, HIV becomes **undetectable and untransmittable (U=U)** through sex [9]

2 SAFER INJECTION

Why Does it Matter



Nearly 1 in 4 new HIV infections in Canada were among people who inject drugs [15]

Don't Share Equipment

- Always use new, sterile needles and syringes [10]
- Never share injection equipment, as HIV can spread through contaminated blood [11]



Supervised Consumption Sites

Safe spaces provide free sterile needles, trained staff, supervised injection, testing, and referrals [12]



These sites do NOT increase drug use or crime [16]



Harm Reduction **WORKS!**

Syringe service programs are linked to a reduction in HIV incidence

50%

in **HIV and Hepatitis C** in 2026 [13]



KNOW your status and REDUCE unintentional spread! [8]

THE ONTARIO GOVERNMENT

The provincial government is working with community organizations to achieve widespread viral suppression

- Slowed the spread of HIV
- Increased PrEP use in at risk populations
- Maintained a low rate of first-time diagnoses related to injectable drugs [4]

HARM REDUCTION SAVES LIVES

Education, prevention, and accessible healthcare reduce HIV transmission and stigma. Everyone deserves safe, respectful, and judgment-free support.



Check out our References



Reach out For Support!



Learn More About HIV Here!

